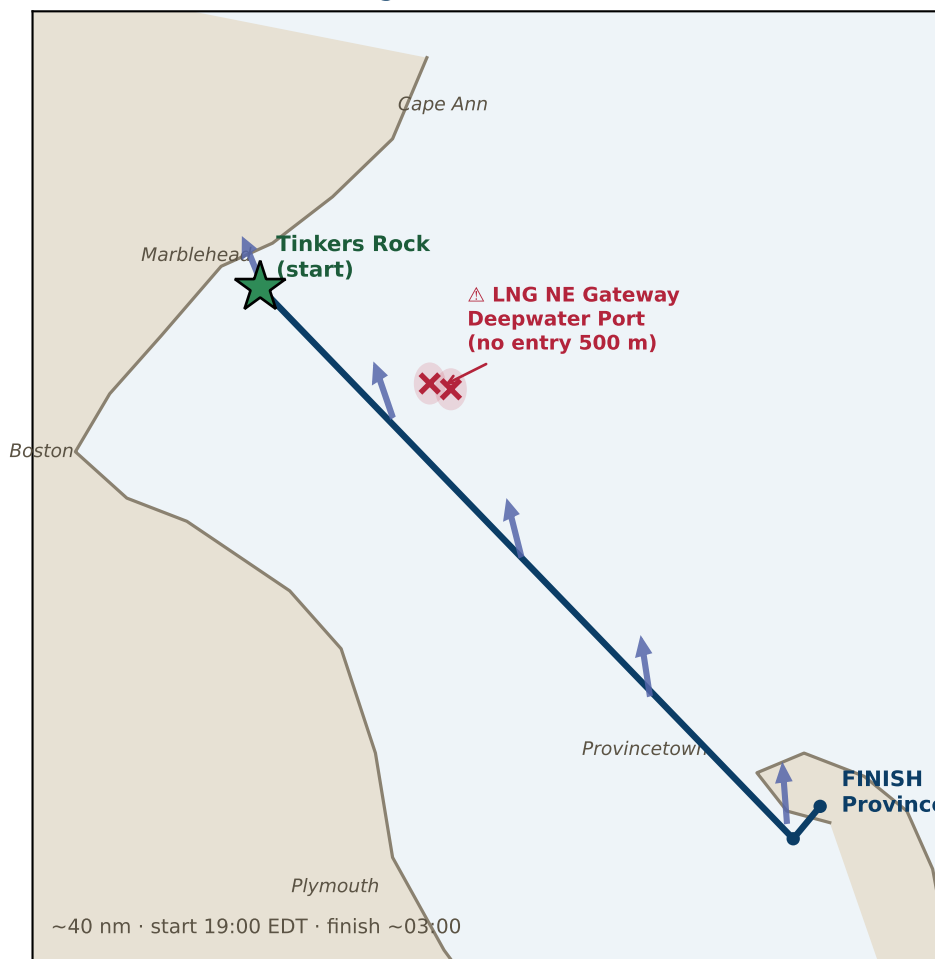


# Marblehead → Provincetown — Overnight Race Weather

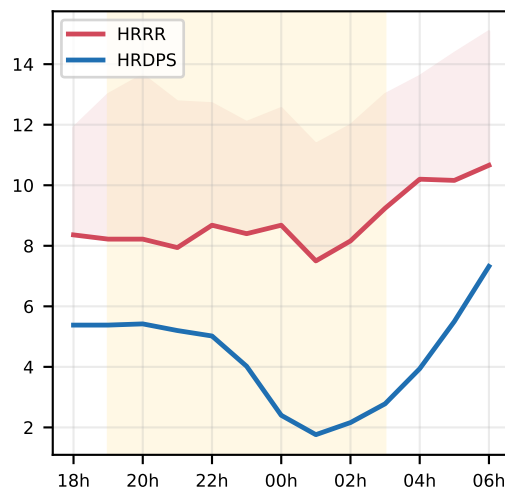
Friday 2026-07-17, 19:00 EDT start · ~03:00 Sat finish · ~40 nm SE across Massachusetts & Cape Cod Bays

Models: NOAA HRRR 3 km + Environment Canada HRDPS 2.5 km (Open-Meteo) · generated 2026-07-16 19:23Z · ~24 h lead — refine race morning

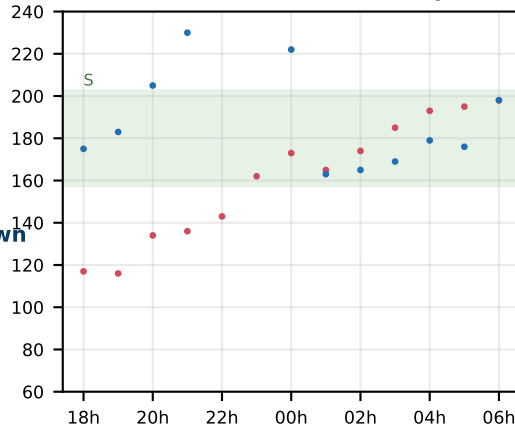
## Route & overnight wind (HRRR mean arrows)



## Course-mean wind (kt)



## Wind dir (° from, mid-bay)



## Overnight synopsis

Light, weak-gradient southerly night (flat ~1016 mb, no front). The models AGREE on the overnight: the wind fills S/SW 8-12 kt offshore, a starboard-tack reach that gradually frees toward Race Point, seas ≤2 ft. They SHARPLY DISAGREE on the start: NOAA HRRR has SE ~10 kt (a reach/beat down the rhumb) while Canada HRDPS shows a NW land-breeze ~7 kt (offshore), dying to near-calm by ~01:00 before the southerly fills — opposite first-leg angles. HRDPS has verified better locally this season, but at a post-sunset transition neither is reliable: sail the breeze that's actually on the water, then get offshore into the steadier southerly. Hour-by-hour, tactics, tide and hazards overleaf.

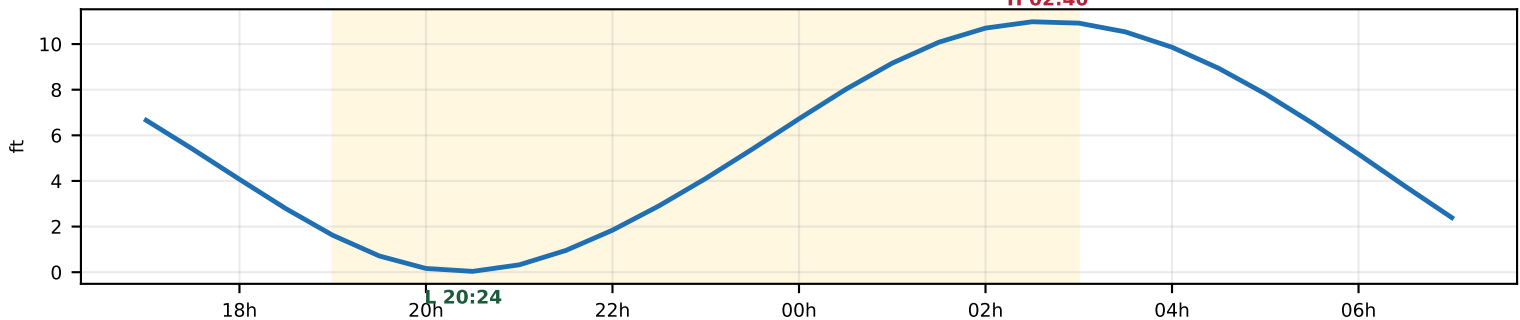
# Tactics, Strategy & Timing

Marblehead → Provincetown · Fri 2026-07-17 overnight

**Corridor wind — dir°/kt, H=HRRR (top) / C=HRDPS (bottom)**

| Time ET      | Start (Tinkers Rk) | Off Nahant      | Mid Mass Bay    | Stellwagen edge | Race Pt / P-town |
|--------------|--------------------|-----------------|-----------------|-----------------|------------------|
| 19:00 H<br>C | 128/10<br>285/8    | 117/7<br>268/7  | 116/8<br>183/4  | 140/8<br>164/5  | 158/8<br>161/3   |
| 21:00 H<br>C | 127/7<br>309/6     | 125/7<br>311/6  | 136/10<br>230/2 | 145/8<br>180/5  | 157/8<br>192/6   |
| 23:00 H<br>C | 146/7<br>321/4     | 150/8<br>333/4  | 162/9<br>319/1  | 170/10<br>212/4 | 170/8<br>213/8   |
| 01:00 H<br>C | 189/3<br>268/1     | 175/7<br>127/1  | 165/8<br>163/1  | 179/10<br>204/2 | 184/10<br>221/4  |
| 03:00 H<br>C | 157/5<br>155/3     | 177/10<br>160/4 | 185/11<br>169/3 | 186/11<br>175/2 | 188/9<br>203/2   |
| 05:00 H<br>C | 197/11<br>190/5    | 189/9<br>186/6  | 195/11<br>176/5 | 192/11<br>166/5 | 190/9<br>180/6   |

**Tide at Boston (proxy) — start ≈ low slack, finish ≈ high slack**



## Tactics & strategy

### ① Start (19:00-21:00) — models disagree, so read the water

HRRR: SE ~10 kt (reach/close-hauled). HRDPS: NW land-breeze ~7 kt (offshore), dying to calm ~01:00. Opposite angles — don't pre-commit. Sail the actual dock breeze; whatever it is it's LIGHT (≤8 kt). Get clear air off the line, then work OFFSHORE — the Marblehead shore is the light trap.

### ② The crossing (21:00-01:00) — reach in the filling southerly

Both models fill S/SW 8-12 kt offshore — a starboard reach that frees as the wind veers right. Pressure lives offshore/south (mid-bay ~10 kt vs shore 2-6). Commit south; stay on the pressure side, don't over-stand north toward Cape Ann.

### ③ ⚠️ LNG Northeast Gateway — hard avoid

Two STL buoys at ~42.40 N (−70.60/−70.59) sit just N of the direct line. NO ENTRY within 500 m, no anchoring within ~1 nm. The rhumb passes ~5 nm south — staying on/south of the line is both faster (more breeze) and legal.

### ④ Race Point & finish (01:00-03:00) — the tide gate

S/SSW 8-11 kt, gusts to 15 into Cape Cod Bay. Flood builds to Boston high 02:45 ≈ finish. Round Race Point BEFORE ~02:45 to carry the flood in; later boats meet the building ebb. Finish current itself is minor (near high slack).

### ⑤ Night & hazards

Dark — thin crescent sets early, so nav by instruments, watches + lights set. Fog watch: July S-flow over cool water; NWS not flagging Fri night but recheck AM. Seas ≤2 ft, no Small Craft Advisory expected.

*Confidence: moderate on the overnight reach + tide timing (models agree); low on the exact start (transition + lead). Re-run race morning + pre-start.*